

for money, without pricing being distorted by other factors. It is certainly good news for Indian clients.

Q: India remains a relatively small market for Swiss-made watches compared with markets such as the US, China, and Japan. What are the biggest challenges?

A: I do not see India as a short-term commercial opportunity. I see it as a long-term growth engine for watchmaking. That is why we are approaching growth with a long-term perspective. For Bvlgari, there are two key challenges. The first is brand awareness. The second is retail expansion. How the retail network develops, and how it creates the right environment for our brand and other watchmakers, will be critical.

Q: Are you targeting younger luxury consumers as well as established collectors?

A: I do not like to talk too specifically about generations. Whether you are a millennial or Gen Z, luxury fundamentally represents craftsmanship, eternity and the transmission of savoir-faire from one generation to the next. When I meet young watch collectors, they are very knowledgeable. They ask precise questions about the technical aspects of watches, where they are made and how they are crafted. When they choose a mechanical Swiss watch over something such as an Apple Watch, they are looking for something that goes beyond a product's functional benefits. What is changing is how brands communicate with younger consumers: where they communicate, how they communicate, whether they use celebrities, sell online or engage through social networks.

The way brands interact with these consumers is changing, not necessarily the product or the desire behind it. Ultimately, buying a luxury watch is about emotion. You do not need a $20,000 watch for its functional benefits. You buy it because of a desire that comes from within. That emotional connection is what creates the magic.

Q: What are Bvlgari's priorities for the next five years in watchmaking, particularly in India?

A: We have three core priorities. First, we will continue nurturing our global icons, Serpenti and Finissimo. They are becoming increasingly relevant to a wider clientele. Second, we want to surprise our clients. Innovation is part of Bvlgari's DNA, including through collaborations in jewellery and watchmaking. Our collaboration with watchmaker Vianney Halter is one example. We will continue bringing unique creativity and innovation to the industry. Third, I strongly believe in women's watchmaking. It represents a major opportunity, not only through jewellery-inspired designs but increasingly through mechanical expertise.

The expertise we have developed with Finissimo is now being applied to women's watches, including thinner, more miniature movements. Women are becoming more interested in watchmaking, which is wonderful for a brand that began as a jeweller with a strong connection to women.

Q: Can we expect any collaborations specifically for India or Indian consumers?

A: I will have to come back and talk to you about that. But the deeper a culture is, and the more resonance it carries, the more interesting it can be for a brand like Bvlgari. Indian culture has many symbols that one day the brand could use. BT

@tweettokarishma